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THE 1930s

The “golden age” of aviation brought aircraft that were safer and more reliable than ever before. But the glamour of air travel remained the province of the wealthy, who could afford the high-ticket prices of the time.

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THE 1940s

The outbreak of World War II drove the innovations of the time, which included high-speed long-range bombers that changed the face of modern warfare. After the war, large numbers of piston-engined aircraft were used for commercial transport until superseded by jet power.

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